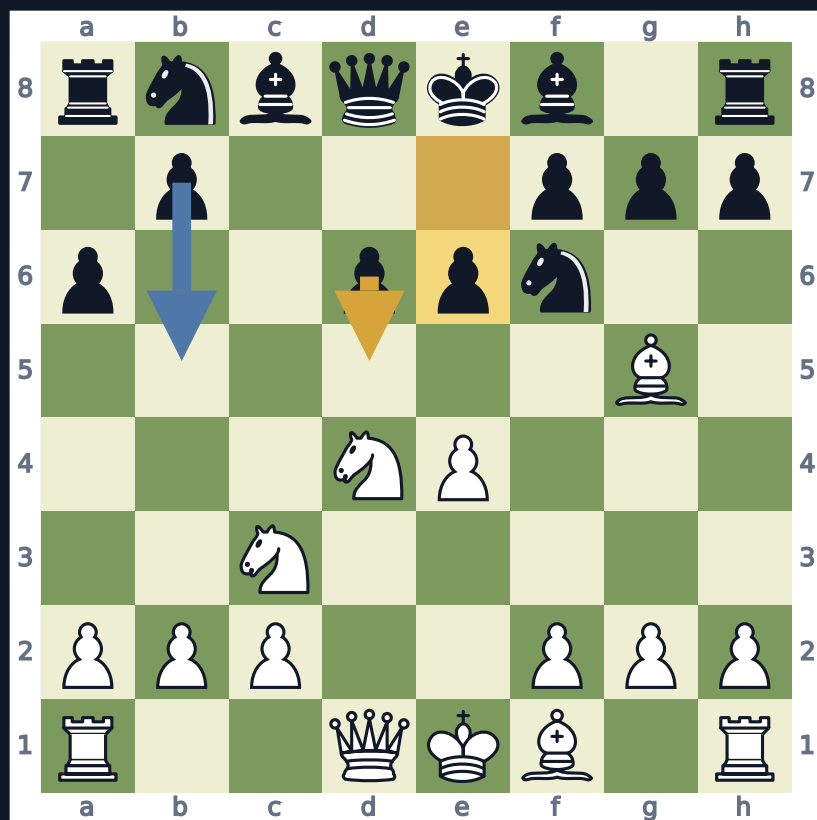


06

Najdorf 6.Bg5

The pin, the e6 tension, and the Poisoned Pawn: calculate the center before chasing material.



THIS VOLUME

6

deep lessons

12

lesson positions

30

course pages

You will understand why 6.Bg5 creates so much theory and how to organize calculation around e6, f6, d5, and king safety.

LEARN THE STRUCTURE, THEN THE LINE

A four-pass method for a theory-heavy opening

1. DECODE THE POSITION

Read the board before the moves. Name the center, each side's break, the worst piece, the king-safety difference, and the race clock.

2. UNDERSTAND THE CAUSAL CHAIN

Every recommendation connects a cue to a reason and a consequence. If you know only the move, you do not yet know the opening.

3. PLAY THE DECISION

Generate Black's candidates, find White's strongest reply, and choose the resulting structure you understand. The move is the end of the reasoning, not the beginning.

4. RETRIEVE UNDER PRESSURE

Cover the answer key, reconstruct the line, and speak the memory rule. Review after 1, 3, 7, 14, and 30 days, then test the idea in a slow game.

THEORY WARNING

This is a durable concept-first repertoire, not a claim to be a live engine database. Before tournament use, verify sharp forcing branches in Fritz or a current database.

Priority order at the board: legality and tactical survival, king safety, forcing moves, central transformation, activity, structure, then the remembered rule.

SIX LINKED LESSONS

Recognition first, execution second

LESSON 031 | PAGE 4

Decode: Classical 6...e6 development*Against Bg5, the center is tactical because the f6 defender is pinned.*

LESSON 032 | PAGE 8

Play: Classical 6...e6 development*Against Bg5, the center is tactical because the f6 defender is pinned.*

LESSON 033 | PAGE 12

Decode: Poisoned Pawn queen expedition*A poisoned pawn is safe only after calculating the queen's route home.*

LESSON 034 | PAGE 16

Play: Poisoned Pawn queen expedition*A poisoned pawn is safe only after calculating the queen's route home.*

LESSON 035 | PAGE 20

Decode: The queenside race after long castling*The center can end a wing race before the pawns reach their targets.*

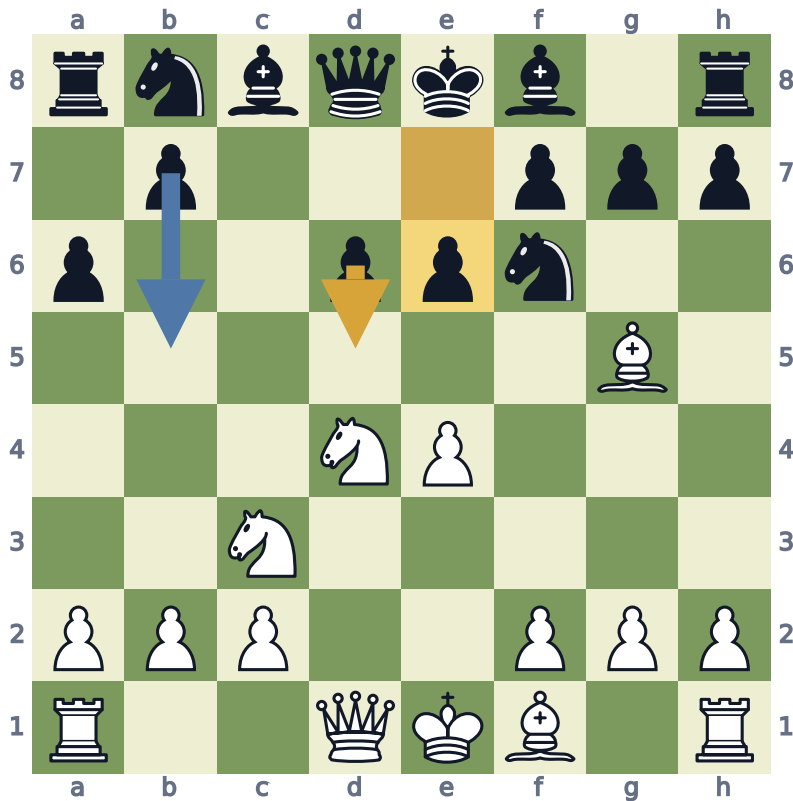
LESSON 036 | PAGE 24

Play: The queenside race after long castling*The center can end a wing race before the pawns reach their targets.***VOLUME OBJECTIVE**

You will understand why 6.Bg5 creates so much theory and how to organize calculation around e6, f6, d5, and king safety.

DECODE PASS | STRUCTURAL DECISION POINT

Decode: Classical 6...e6 development



WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS

The pin increases pressure on f6 and makes e5 a tactical possibility; Black builds a position that can answer central contact.

DECISION RULE

If White plays e5 now, what are every capture and discovered attack on f6 and e6?

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S JOB

Unpin or reinforce f6, develop the queenside, and meet e5 with calculation rather than a reflex.

WHITE'S COUNTERPLAY

White combines Qf3, long castling, f5, and e5 to exploit the pinned knight and the e6 pawn.

MEMORY RULE | Against Bg5, the center is tactical because the f6 defender is pinned.

CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



CUE

The pin increases pressure on f6 and makes e5 a tactical possibility; Black builds a position that can answer central contact.

BLACK AIMS FOR

Unpin or reinforce f6, develop the queenside, and meet e5 with calculation rather than a reflex.

FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

White

WHITE'S BEST PRACTICAL IDEA

White combines Qf3, long castling, f5, and e5 to exploit the pinned knight and the e6 pawn.

FAILURE MODE

Castling or expanding without calculating the immediate e5 break.

DECISION TEST

Ask: If White plays e5 now, what are every capture and discovered attack on f6 and e6? Then compare at least two candidates against White's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

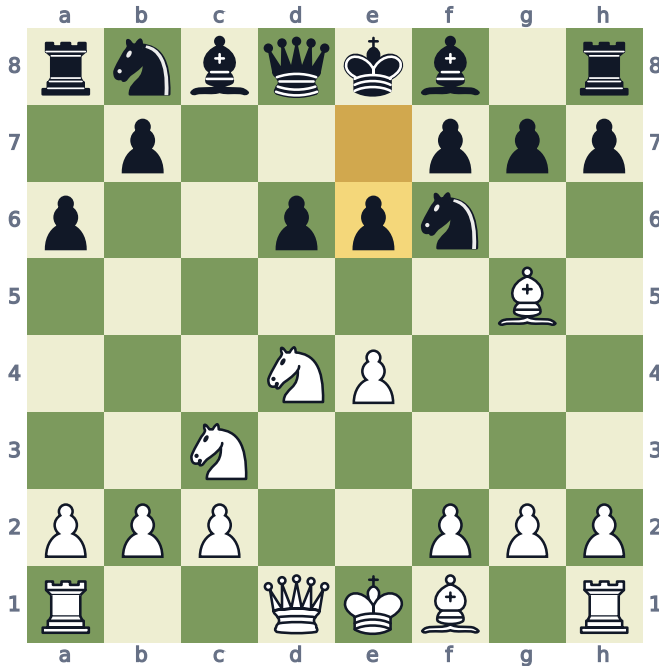
RULE | Against Bg5, the center is tactical because the f6 defender is pinned.

INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 d6 3. d4 cxd4 4. Nxd4 Nf6 5. Nc3 a6 6. Bg5 e6 7. f4 Be7 8. Qf3 Qc7 9. O-O-O Nbd7



- Nxd4: White releases tension by capturing on d4; recalculate the pawn skeleton, open lines, and the opponent's most forcing recapture.
- Nf6: Black reroutes a knight to f6; judge the move by the job at its destination and the time conceded on the way.
- Nc3: White reroutes a knight to c3; judge the move by the job at its destination and the time conceded on the way.
- a6: Black changes the pawn skeleton; reassess breaks, weak squares, open lines, and king exposure.
- Bg5: White changes a bishop's diagonal; identify the central pawn move that will make that diagonal useful.
- e6: Black changes the pawn skeleton; reassess breaks, weak squares, open lines, and king exposure.

WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

The pin increases pressure on f6 and makes e5 a tactical possibility; Black builds a position that can answer central contact.

WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

If White plays e5 now, what are every capture and discovered attack on f6 and e6? White's resistance is: White combines Qf3, long castling, f5, and e5 to exploit the pinned knight and the e6 pawn. The line fails as a template when: Castling or expanding without calculating the immediate e5 break.

STORE THIS | Against Bg5, the center is tactical because the f6 defender is pinned.

COVER THE ANSWER KEY AND SPEAK EACH ANSWER

Retrieval and self-coaching

1. What center or structural transition defines this position?

2. What is Black's primary plan, and which piece or pawn enables it?

3. What is White's fastest or most forcing counterplay?

4. What exact question decides the next move?

5. What is the most dangerous way to misuse the remembered plan?

ANSWER KEY

1. The pin increases pressure on f6 and makes e5 a tactical possibility; Black builds a position that can answer central contact. 2. Unpin or reinforce f6, develop the queenside, and meet e5 with calculation rather than a reflex. 3. White combines Qf3, long castling, f5, and e5 to exploit the pinned knight and the e6 pawn. 4. If White plays e5 now, what are every capture and discovered attack on f6 and e6? 5. Castling or expanding without calculating the immediate e5 break.

BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 12 plies from memory, then replay: 4. Nxd4 Nf6 5. Nc3 a6 6. Bg5 e6

PLAY PASS | PLAN EXECUTION AND TACTICAL CONTACT

Play: Classical 6...e6 development



WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS

The pin increases pressure on f6 and makes e5 a tactical possibility; Black builds a position that can answer central contact.

DECISION RULE

If White plays e5 now, what are every capture and discovered attack on f6 and e6?

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S JOB

Unpin or reinforce f6, develop the queenside, and meet e5 with calculation rather than a reflex.

WHITE'S COUNTERPLAY

White combines Qf3, long castling, f5, and e5 to exploit the pinned knight and the e6 pawn.

MEMORY RULE | Against Bg5, the center is tactical because the f6 defender is pinned.

CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



CUE

The pin increases pressure on f6 and makes e5 a tactical possibility; Black builds a position that can answer central contact.

BLACK AIMS FOR

Unpin or reinforce f6, develop the queenside, and meet e5 with calculation rather than a reflex.

FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

White

WHITE'S BEST PRACTICAL IDEA

White combines Qf3, long castling, f5, and e5 to exploit the pinned knight and the e6 pawn.

FAILURE MODE

Castling or expanding without calculating the immediate e5 break.

DECISION TEST

Ask: If White plays e5 now, what are every capture and discovered attack on f6 and e6? Then compare at least two candidates against White's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

RULE | Against Bg5, the center is tactical because the f6 defender is pinned.

INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 d6 3. d4 cxd4 4. Nxd4 Nf6 5. Nc3 a6 6. Bg5 e6 7. f4 Be7 8. Qf3 Qc7 9. O-O-O Nbd7



- f4: White claims kingside space and announces e5 or f5 attacking ideas.
- Be7: Black changes a bishop's diagonal; identify the central pawn move that will make that diagonal useful.
- Qf3: White coordinates several plans, but the queen's safety and the opponent's forcing reply must be checked.
- Qc7: Black coordinates several plans, but the queen's safety and the opponent's forcing reply must be checked.
- O-O-O: White secures the king and connects a rook; central and wing operations can now be judged more concretely.
- Nbd7: Black reroutes a knight to d7; judge the move by the job at its destination and the time conceded on the way.

WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

The pin increases pressure on f6 and makes e5 a tactical possibility; Black builds a position that can answer central contact.

WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

If White plays e5 now, what are every capture and discovered attack on f6 and e6? White's resistance is: White combines Qf3, long castling, f5, and e5 to exploit the pinned knight and the e6 pawn. The line fails as a template when: Castling or expanding without calculating the immediate e5 break.

STORE THIS | Against Bg5, the center is tactical because the f6 defender is pinned.

COVER THE ANSWER KEY AND SPEAK EACH ANSWER

Retrieval and self-coaching

1. What center or structural transition defines this position?

2. What is Black's primary plan, and which piece or pawn enables it?

3. What is White's fastest or most forcing counterplay?

4. What exact question decides the next move?

5. What is the most dangerous way to misuse the remembered plan?

ANSWER KEY

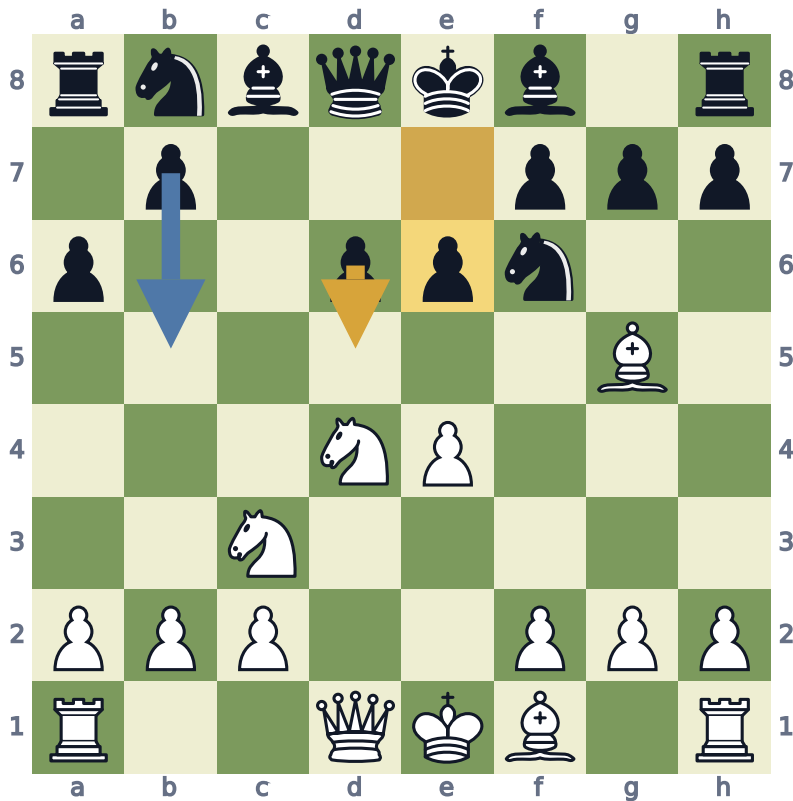
1. The pin increases pressure on f6 and makes e5 a tactical possibility; Black builds a position that can answer central contact. 2. Unpin or reinforce f6, develop the queenside, and meet e5 with calculation rather than a reflex. 3. White combines Qf3, long castling, f5, and e5 to exploit the pinned knight and the e6 pawn. 4. If White plays e5 now, what are every capture and discovered attack on f6 and e6? 5. Castling or expanding without calculating the immediate e5 break.

BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 18 plies from memory, then replay: 7. f4 Be7 8. Qf3 Qc7 9. O-O-O Nbd7

DECODE PASS | STRUCTURAL DECISION POINT

Decode: Poisoned Pawn queen expedition

**WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS**

Black wins b2 but sends the queen far from the king. Material matters only if the queen escapes and development catches up.

DECISION RULE

Before taking b2, can the queen survive White's forcing sequence and can Black answer the next central break?

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S JOB

Know the evacuation squares, return the queen when necessary, and meet central threats with exact moves.

WHITE'S COUNTERPLAY

White uses e5, f5, and direct piece development to trap the queen or attack the uncastled king.

MEMORY RULE | A poisoned pawn is safe only after calculating the queen's route home.

CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



CUE

Black wins b2 but sends the queen far from the king. Material matters only if the queen escapes and development catches up.

BLACK AIMS FOR

Know the evacuation squares, return the queen when necessary, and meet central threats with exact moves.

FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

White

WHITE'S BEST PRACTICAL IDEA

White uses e5, f5, and direct piece development to trap the queen or attack the uncastled king.

FAILURE MODE

Counting the extra pawn while ignoring lost tempi and a trapped queen.

DECISION TEST

Ask: Before taking b2, can the queen survive White's forcing sequence and can Black answer the next central break? Then compare at least two candidates against White's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

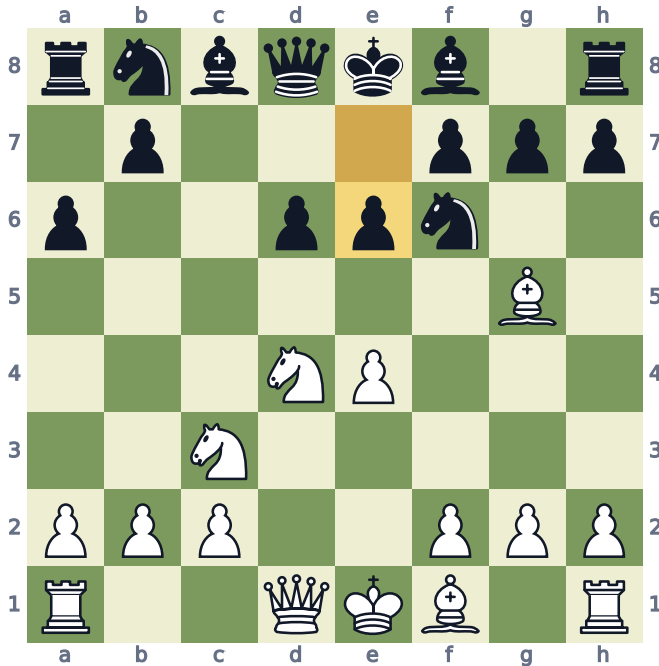
RULE | A poisoned pawn is safe only after calculating the queen's route home.

INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 d6 3. d4 cxd4 4. Nxd4 Nf6 5. Nc3 a6 6. Bg5 e6 7. f4 Qb6 8. Qd2 Qxb2 9. Rb1 Qa3



- Nxd4: White releases tension by capturing on d4; recalculate the pawn skeleton, open lines, and the opponent's most forcing recapture.
- Nf6: Black reroutes a knight to f6; judge the move by the job at its destination and the time conceded on the way.
- Nc3: White reroutes a knight to c3; judge the move by the job at its destination and the time conceded on the way.
- a6: Black changes the pawn skeleton; reassess breaks, weak squares, open lines, and king exposure.
- Bg5: White changes a bishop's diagonal; identify the central pawn move that will make that diagonal useful.
- e6: Black changes the pawn skeleton; reassess breaks, weak squares, open lines, and king exposure.

WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

Black wins b2 but sends the queen far from the king. Material matters only if the queen escapes and development catches up.

WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

Before taking b2, can the queen survive White's forcing sequence and can Black answer the next central break? White's resistance is: White uses e5, f5, and direct piece development to trap the queen or attack the uncaptured king. The line fails as a template when: Counting the extra pawn while ignoring lost tempi and a trapped queen.

STORE THIS | A poisoned pawn is safe only after calculating the queen's route home.

COVER THE ANSWER KEY AND SPEAK EACH ANSWER

Retrieval and self-coaching

1. What center or structural transition defines this position?

2. What is Black's primary plan, and which piece or pawn enables it?

3. What is White's fastest or most forcing counterplay?

4. What exact question decides the next move?

5. What is the most dangerous way to misuse the remembered plan?

ANSWER KEY

1. Black wins b2 but sends the queen far from the king. Material matters only if the queen escapes and development catches up. 2. Know the evacuation squares, return the queen when necessary, and meet central threats with exact moves. 3. White uses e5, f5, and direct piece development to trap the queen or attack the uncastled king. 4. Before taking b2, can the queen survive White's forcing sequence and can Black answer the next central break? 5. Counting the extra pawn while ignoring lost tempi and a trapped queen.

BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 12 plies from memory, then replay: 4. Nxd4 Nf6 5. Nc3 a6 6. Bg5 e6

PLAY PASS | PLAN EXECUTION AND TACTICAL CONTACT

Play: Poisoned Pawn queen expedition



WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS

Black wins b2 but sends the queen far from the king. Material matters only if the queen escapes and development catches up.

DECISION RULE

Before taking b2, can the queen survive White's forcing sequence and can Black answer the next central break?

SIDE TO MOVE

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Know the evacuation squares, return the queen when necessary, and meet central threats with exact moves.

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CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



CUE

Black wins b2 but sends the queen far from the king. Material matters only if the queen escapes and development catches up.

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Know the evacuation squares, return the queen when necessary, and meet central threats with exact moves.

FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

White

WHITE'S BEST PRACTICAL IDEA

White uses e5, f5, and direct piece development to trap the queen or attack the uncastled king.

FAILURE MODE

Counting the extra pawn while ignoring lost tempi and a trapped queen.

DECISION TEST

Ask: Before taking b2, can the queen survive White's forcing sequence and can Black answer the next central break? Then compare at least two candidates against White's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

RULE | A poisoned pawn is safe only after calculating the queen's route home.

INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 d6 3. d4 cxd4 4. Nxd4 Nf6 5. Nc3 a6 6. Bg5 e6 7. f4 Qb6 8. Qd2 Qxb2 9. Rb1 Qa3



- f4: White claims kingside space and announces e5 or f5 attacking ideas.
- Qb6: Black coordinates several plans, but the queen's safety and the opponent's forcing reply must be checked.
- Qd2: White coordinates several plans, but the queen's safety and the opponent's forcing reply must be checked.
- Qxb2: Black releases tension by capturing on b2; recalculate the pawn skeleton, open lines, and the opponent's most forcing recapture.
- Rb1: White places a rook behind a file or pawn break expected to become important.
- Qa3: Black coordinates several plans, but the queen's safety and the opponent's forcing reply must be checked.

WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

Black wins b2 but sends the queen far from the king. Material matters only if the queen escapes and development catches up.

WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

Before taking b2, can the queen survive White's forcing sequence and can Black answer the next central break? White's resistance is: White uses e5, f5, and direct piece development to trap the queen or attack the uncaptured king. The line fails as a template when: Counting the extra pawn while ignoring lost tempi and a trapped queen.

STORE THIS | A poisoned pawn is safe only after calculating the queen's route home.

COVER THE ANSWER KEY AND SPEAK EACH ANSWER

Retrieval and self-coaching

1. What center or structural transition defines this position?

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3. What is White's fastest or most forcing counterplay?

4. What exact question decides the next move?

5. What is the most dangerous way to misuse the remembered plan?

ANSWER KEY

1. Black wins b2 but sends the queen far from the king. Material matters only if the queen escapes and development catches up. 2. Know the evacuation squares, return the queen when necessary, and meet central threats with exact moves. 3. White uses e5, f5, and direct piece development to trap the queen or attack the uncastled king. 4. Before taking b2, can the queen survive White's forcing sequence and can Black answer the next central break? 5. Counting the extra pawn while ignoring lost tempi and a trapped queen.

BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 18 plies from memory, then replay: 7. f4 Qb6 8. Qd2 Qxb2 9. Rb1 Qa3

DECODE PASS | STRUCTURAL DECISION POINT

Decode: The queenside race after long castling



WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS

Once White castles long, ...b5 gains tactical force, but central contact can open lines against either king before the pawn storm arrives.

DECISION RULE

Is the wing attack faster than White's central forcing line?

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S JOB

Combine ...b5 with ...Bb7 and calculate e5; open files only when Black's king has a defensible destination.

WHITE'S COUNTERPLAY

White strikes e5 or f5 to make the center explode while Black's king remains undecided.

MEMORY RULE | The center can end a wing race before the pawns reach their targets.

CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



CUE

Once White castles long, ...b5 gains tactical force, but central contact can open lines against either king before the pawn storm arrives.

BLACK AIMS FOR

Combine ...b5 with ...Bb7 and calculate e5; open files only when Black's king has a defensible destination.

FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

White

WHITE'S BEST PRACTICAL IDEA

White strikes e5 or f5 to make the center explode while Black's king remains undecided.

FAILURE MODE

Assuming opposite-side castling makes every pawn push automatically correct.

DECISION TEST

Ask: Is the wing attack faster than White's central forcing line? Then compare at least two candidates against White's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

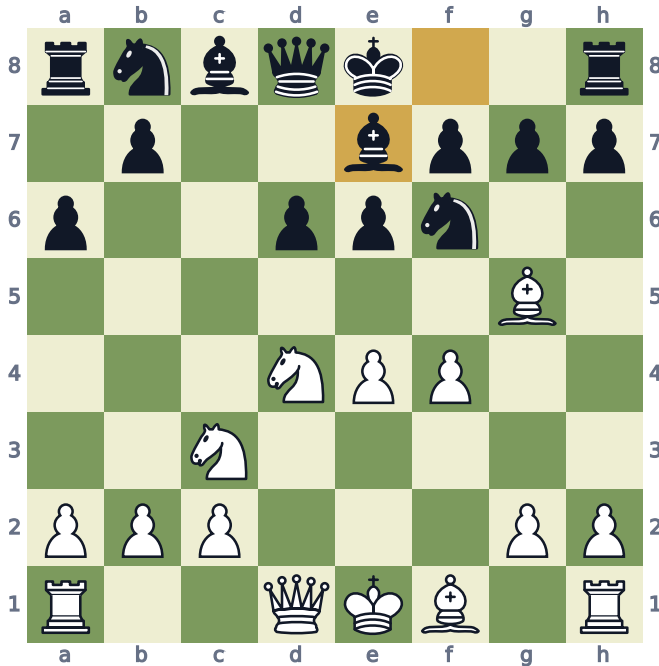
RULE | The center can end a wing race before the pawns reach their targets.

INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 d6 3. d4 cxd4 4. Nxd4 Nf6 5. Nc3 a6 6. Bg5 e6 7. f4 Be7 8. Qf3 Qc7 9. O-O-O b5 10. e5 Bb7



- Nc3: White reroutes a knight to c3; judge the move by the job at its destination and the time conceded on the way.
- a6: Black changes the pawn skeleton; reassess breaks, weak squares, open lines, and king exposure.
- Bg5: White changes a bishop's diagonal; identify the central pawn move that will make that diagonal useful.
- e6: Black changes the pawn skeleton; reassess breaks, weak squares, open lines, and king exposure.
- f4: White claims kingside space and announces e5 or f5 attacking ideas.
- Be7: Black changes a bishop's diagonal; identify the central pawn move that will make that diagonal useful.

WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

Once White castles long, ...b5 gains tactical force, but central contact can open lines against either king before the pawn storm arrives.

WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

Is the wing attack faster than White's central forcing line? White's resistance is: White strikes e5 or f5 to make the center explode while Black's king remains undecided. The line fails as a template when: Assuming opposite-side castling makes every pawn push automatically correct.

STORE THIS | The center can end a wing race before the pawns reach their targets.

COVER THE ANSWER KEY AND SPEAK EACH ANSWER

Retrieval and self-coaching

1. What center or structural transition defines this position?

2. What is Black's primary plan, and which piece or pawn enables it?

3. What is White's fastest or most forcing counterplay?

4. What exact question decides the next move?

5. What is the most dangerous way to misuse the remembered plan?

ANSWER KEY

1. Once White castles long, ...b5 gains tactical force, but central contact can open lines against either king before the pawn storm arrives. 2. Combine ...b5 with ...Bb7 and calculate e5; open files only when Black's king has a defensible destination. 3. White strikes e5 or f5 to make the center explode while Black's king remains undecided. 4. Is the wing attack faster than White's central forcing line? 5. Assuming opposite-side castling makes every pawn push automatically correct.

BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 14 plies from memory, then replay: 5. Nc3 a6 6. Bg5 e6 7. f4 Be7

Play: The queenside race after long castling



DECISION RULE

SIDE TO MOVE

White

Combine ...b5 with ...Bb7 and calculate e5; open files only when Black's king has a defensible destination.

White strikes e5 or f5 to make the center explode while Black's king remains undecided.

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CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



CUE

Once White castles long, ...b5 gains tactical force, but central contact can open lines against either king before the pawn storm arrives.

BLACK AIMS FOR

Combine ...b5 with ...Bb7 and calculate e5; open files only when Black's king has a defensible destination.

FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

White

WHITE'S BEST PRACTICAL IDEA

White strikes e5 or f5 to make the center explode while Black's king remains undecided.

FAILURE MODE

Assuming opposite-side castling makes every pawn push automatically correct.

DECISION TEST

Ask: Is the wing attack faster than White's central forcing line? Then compare at least two candidates against White's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

RULE | The center can end a wing race before the pawns reach their targets.

INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 d6 3. d4 cxd4 4. Nxd4 Nf6 5. Nc3 a6 6. Bg5 e6 7. f4 Be7 8. Qf3 Qc7 9. O-O-O b5 10. e5 Bb7



- Qf3: White coordinates several plans, but the queen's safety and the opponent's forcing reply must be checked.
- Qc7: Black coordinates several plans, but the queen's safety and the opponent's forcing reply must be checked.
- O-O-O: White secures the king and connects a rook; central and wing operations can now be judged more concretely.
- b5: Black starts queenside expansion and prepares files or a bishop diagonal.
- e5: White changes the pawn skeleton; reassess breaks, weak squares, open lines, and king exposure.
- Bb7: Black changes a bishop's diagonal; identify the central pawn move that will make that diagonal useful.

WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

Once White castles long, ...b5 gains tactical force, but central contact can open lines against either king before the pawn storm arrives.

WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

Is the wing attack faster than White's central forcing line? White's resistance is: White strikes e5 or f5 to make the center explode while Black's king remains undecided. The line fails as a template when: Assuming opposite-side castling makes every pawn push automatically correct.

STORE THIS | The center can end a wing race before the pawns reach their targets.

COVER THE ANSWER KEY AND SPEAK EACH ANSWER

Retrieval and self-coaching

1. What center or structural transition defines this position?

2. What is Black's primary plan, and which piece or pawn enables it?

3. What is White's fastest or most forcing counterplay?

4. What exact question decides the next move?

5. What is the most dangerous way to misuse the remembered plan?

ANSWER KEY

1. Once White castles long, ...b5 gains tactical force, but central contact can open lines against either king before the pawn storm arrives. 2. Combine ...b5 with ...Bb7 and calculate e5; open files only when Black's king has a defensible destination. 3. White strikes e5 or f5 to make the center explode while Black's king remains undecided. 4. Is the wing attack faster than White's central forcing line? 5. Assuming opposite-side castling makes every pawn push automatically correct.

BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 20 plies from memory, then replay: 8. Qf3 Qc7 9. O-O-O b5 10. e5 Bb7

SIX-POSITION TEST

Can you retrieve the plan without the chapter?

LESSON 031 Decode: Classical 6...e6 development

Prompt: If White plays e5 now, what are every capture and discovered attack on f6 and e6?

Recall: Against Bg5, the center is tactical because the f6 defender is pinned.

LESSON 032 Play: Classical 6...e6 development

Prompt: If White plays e5 now, what are every capture and discovered attack on f6 and e6?

Recall: Against Bg5, the center is tactical because the f6 defender is pinned.

LESSON 033 Decode: Poisoned Pawn queen expedition

Prompt: Before taking b2, can the queen survive White's forcing sequence and can Black answer the next central break?

Recall: A poisoned pawn is safe only after calculating the queen's route home.

LESSON 034 Play: Poisoned Pawn queen expedition

Prompt: Before taking b2, can the queen survive White's forcing sequence and can Black answer the next central break?

Recall: A poisoned pawn is safe only after calculating the queen's route home.

LESSON 035 Decode: The queenside race after long castling

Prompt: Is the wing attack faster than White's central forcing line?

Recall: The center can end a wing race before the pawns reach their targets.

LESSON 036 Play: The queenside race after long castling

Prompt: Is the wing attack faster than White's central forcing line?

Recall: The center can end a wing race before the pawns reach their targets.

PASS STANDARD

For each position: name the structure, Black's plan, White's counterplay, one candidate, the strongest reply, and the failure mode. Score one point each; 30 of 36 is a pass.

THREE SCENARIOS TO STORE

One-page repertoire memory sheet

CARD 1

Classical 6...e6 development

1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 d6 3. d4 cxd4 4. Nxd4 Nf6 5. Nc3 a6 6. Bg5 e6 7. f4 Be7 8. Qf3 Qc7 9. O-O-O Nbd7

Decision: If White plays e5 now, what are every capture and discovered attack on f6 and e6?

Memory: Against Bg5, the center is tactical because the f6 defender is pinned.

CARD 2

Poisoned Pawn queen expedition

1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 d6 3. d4 cxd4 4. Nxd4 Nf6 5. Nc3 a6 6. Bg5 e6 7. f4 Qb6 8. Qd2 Qxb2 9. Rb1 Qa3

Decision: Before taking b2, can the queen survive White's forcing sequence and can Black answer the next central break?

Memory: A poisoned pawn is safe only after calculating the queen's route home.

CARD 3

The queenside race after long castling

1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 d6 3. d4 cxd4 4. Nxd4 Nf6 5. Nc3 a6 6. Bg5 e6 7. f4 Be7 8. Qf3 Qc7 9. O-O-O b5 10. e5 Bb7

Decision: Is the wing attack faster than White's central forcing line?

Memory: The center can end a wing race before the pawns reach their targets.

Reconstruct each card from the final position, then from the opening moves alone.

SPACED RETRIEVAL AND GAME TRANSFER

Volume mastery tracker

Lesson	D1	D3	D7	D14	D30	Game	Pass
031 Decode: Classical 6...e6 development	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
032 Play: Classical 6...e6 development	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
033 Decode: Poisoned Pawn queen expedition	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
034 Play: Poisoned Pawn queen expedition	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
035 Decode: The queenside race after long castling	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
036 Play: The queenside race after long castling	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

TWELVE-WEEK CYCLE

Weeks 1-2: decode the three structures. Weeks 3-4: replay all lines from memory. Weeks 5-7: solve the workbook pages. Weeks 8-10: test in slow games or against Fritz. Weeks 11-12: analyze failures and retest the volume examination.

PROMOTION RULE

Advance only when you can explain every memory rule, reproduce the three reference lines, name White's best counterplay, and show at least one analyzed game where the decision appeared.

Do not measure mastery by pages completed. Measure whether the correct questions appear during a real game.